



Setting up a Nix VM

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Category	Nix

NixOS HPC VM Setup Guide

Note: There is a reference configuration.nix in the Jargon repo under

`Nixos/Headnode/`.

You can use this as a reference to see how to install apps, setup ssh, and create a new user. Please do not copy and paste it. Perform changes with intention, EG: Add git → rebuild, Create a user → Rebuild, Install BTOP → rebuild.

Creating the VM:

- **Image:** NixOS Graphical Install (The Intel/AMD one)
 - Link: <https://nixos.org/download/>
- **OS Type:** Linux → Other Linux (Should see Linux (x64) or similar below it)
- **RAM:** At least 4GB for now
- **Disk size:** 20GB

Installing Nixos on VM

- Select the first live boot option at the top (Gnome LTS)
- Go through the install pop-up:
 - Select default language
 - Create a user.
 - **NB: Remeber your user and password!**
(You can even make it **Name:** test, **Password:** test. and later create your

user via configuration.nix

- Disable the strong password if needed
- Tick admin password same as users
- Select no desktop (You will see gnome, kde, etc...) (It'll be at the bottom)
- Finish install
- Don;t accept the reboot and shutdown the VM

Removing the live Installer

- Go to Machine settings, in the boot order, untick:
 - Floppy
 - Optical (This is where the image downloaded is)
- Should only have hard disk left

Sign In

- Sign into your machine. Should see:
 - `Nixos Login:`
 - If you followed guide earlier, use credentials: **Login:** test, **Password:** test

Setup

- From here you can install/build packages, create a new user, setup SSH. See the note on the top of the document for more.
 - Try creating the Selection Round setup: HPL, Chrony, NFS, Slurm (At your own tuime, the learning objective is to understand the workflow).
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